

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Human Resources Policy Manual

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Approved by: Chief People Officer

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Section 1: Leave Policy

Nexora Technologies recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides a comprehensive leave framework to ensure employees can attend to personal, health, and family needs without financial hardship. All leave entitlements reset on January 1st of each calendar year unless stated otherwise.

1.1 Leave Eligibility

All full-time permanent employees of Nexora Technologies are eligible for the leave benefits described in this section, effective from their date of joining. Contract employees, consultants, and interns are governed by the terms of their individual contracts and are not covered under this policy unless explicitly stated.

1.2 Types of Leave and Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement & Key Rules
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days per calendar year. Maximum 3 consecutive days at a time. Cannot be combined with Earned Leave. Unused CL lapses at year end and cannot be carried forward or encashed.
Earned Leave (EL) / Privilege Leave (PL)	18 days per calendar year (1.5 days earned per month). Can be accumulated up to 45 days. Excess beyond 45 days is automatically encashed in December. Minimum 5 days must be availed at a time.
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days per calendar year. Medical certificate required for absences exceeding 2 consecutive days. Unused SL up to 30 days may be carried forward.
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (182 days) of fully paid leave for female employees. Applicable for up to 2 surviving children. Adoption leave of 12 weeks for adopting mothers.
Paternity Leave	10 working days of fully paid leave for male employees within 3 months of childbirth or adoption. Non-transferable and non-encashable.
Bereavement Leave	5 working days for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling). 3 days for extended family (grandparent, in-law).
Marriage Leave	5 working days of paid leave once during the tenure of employment, to be availed within 30 days of the marriage date.
Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)	1 day off for each weekend or public holiday worked, to be availed within 60 days. Requires prior manager approval.
Loss of Pay (LOP)	Applicable when all other leave balances are exhausted. Subject to manager and HR approval. Deducted from monthly salary at per-day rate.

1.3 Leave Application Procedure

Employees must follow the procedures below to apply for leave. Failure to follow proper procedure may result in the leave being marked as Loss of Pay.

1. Log into the HR portal at hr.nexora.internal and navigate to 'My Leave'.
2. Select the leave type, start date, end date, and provide a brief reason.
3. Submit the application at least 3 working days in advance for planned leave (Earned Leave, Marriage Leave). For emergency leave (Sick Leave, Bereavement Leave), notify your manager via phone or message and submit the application on the same day or the next working day.
4. Your reporting manager will approve or reject the request within 2 working days.
5. HR will send a confirmation email upon final approval.

Important: Public Holiday & Leave Sandwiching

If an employee takes leave immediately before and after a public holiday or weekend, the intervening holidays/weekends will be counted as leave days. For example, if an employee takes leave on Friday and Monday, Saturday and Sunday will also be deducted from their leave balance.

1.4 Leave Encashment

Earned Leave (EL) beyond the 45-day cap is encashed automatically in December at the gross basic salary rate per day. Employees may also opt for voluntary encashment of up to 10 EL days once per year during the April appraisal cycle. Sick Leave and Casual Leave are not eligible for encashment under any circumstances.

1.5 Maternity & Paternity Leave Details

Maternity Leave

- 26 weeks of fully paid maternity leave for female employees with at least 80 days of service in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery date.
- For a third child or subsequent children, maternity leave is limited to 12 weeks.
- An additional 1 month of unpaid leave may be requested for post-natal health complications, subject to medical documentation.
- The employee's position will be held during maternity leave and she will return to the same or an equivalent role.

Paternity Leave

- 10 working days fully paid, to be availed within 3 months of the birth or legal adoption of a child.
- Must be applied at least 1 week in advance (except in cases of premature birth).
- Available only once per birth/adoption event.

Section 2: Work From Home (WFH) Policy

Nexora Technologies supports a hybrid work model that balances the benefits of in-office collaboration with the flexibility of remote work. This policy applies to all permanent employees unless their role has been designated as 'Office-Mandatory' by the department head.

2.1 Hybrid Work Schedule

The standard hybrid arrangement at Nexora Technologies is 3 days in-office and 2 days remote per week. The specific in-office days are determined at the team level by the reporting manager and must be consistent week-to-week to enable team collaboration.

Employee Band	WFH Entitlement
Band 1 & 2 (Junior Associates)	2 WFH days per week. Minimum 60 days in office per quarter.
Band 3 & 4 (Senior Associates / Team Leads)	2-3 WFH days per week, at manager discretion.
Band 5+ (Managers and above)	Flexible, subject to business requirements and departmental norms.
Probation Period (first 6 months)	Full in-office attendance required. No WFH permitted.

2.2 WFH Eligibility Conditions

Employees must meet all of the following conditions to be eligible for WFH:

- Have successfully completed the 6-month probation period.
- Have a satisfactory performance rating (3 or above on a 5-point scale) in the most recent appraisal.
- Have not received a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) in the last 12 months.
- Have a reliable internet connection of at least 25 Mbps at their remote location.
- Have a dedicated, distraction-free workspace at home.

2.3 WFH Working Hours & Availability

Employees working from home are expected to maintain the same working hours as they would in the office: 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM IST, Monday to Friday, with a 1-hour lunch break. Employees must:

- Be reachable on Slack and email within 15 minutes during core hours (10:00 AM to 5:00 PM IST).
- Attend all scheduled video calls with camera on, unless explicitly told otherwise.
- Log attendance on the HR portal by 9:30 AM on WFH days.
- Notify the manager immediately if there are connectivity issues causing unavailability.

2.4 Equipment & Security

Nexora Technologies provides a company laptop to all permanent employees. Employees are expected to use only company-approved devices and VPN connections when accessing internal systems remotely. The use of personal devices to access company data, HR systems, or client information is strictly prohibited.

2.5 WFH Revocation

The company reserves the right to revoke WFH privileges temporarily or permanently in the following circumstances: project deadlines requiring full team presence, client visits or audits, disciplinary proceedings, performance concerns, or any other business-critical situation as determined by the management. Employees will be given reasonable notice except in urgent cases.

Section 3: Compensation & Benefits

Nexora Technologies is committed to providing competitive, fair, and transparent compensation to attract and retain top talent. This section outlines the salary structure, benefits, and reimbursement policies applicable to all permanent employees.

3.1 Salary Structure

The total cost-to-company (CTC) at Nexora Technologies is structured as follows:

Component	Details
Basic Salary	40% of CTC. Forms the basis for PF, Gratuity, and Leave Encashment calculations.
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	20% of CTC. Fully taxable if employee does not reside in rented accommodation.
Special Allowance	Remaining amount after accounting for other fixed components. Fully taxable.
Provident Fund (PF)	12% of Basic Salary contributed by employee; matched by employer. Deducted at source.
Professional Tax	As per state regulations. Deducted monthly from salary.
Performance Bonus	Variable component; up to 15% of annual CTC based on individual and company performance. Paid annually in April.
Gratuity	Applicable after 5 years of continuous service. Calculated as $(\text{Basic Salary} / 26) \times 15 \times \text{Years of Service}$.

3.2 Salary Disbursement

Salaries are credited to the employee's registered bank account on the last working day of each month. If the last working day falls on a bank holiday, salaries are credited on the preceding working day. Payslips are available on the HR portal by the 3rd of the following month. Queries regarding salary must be raised within 10 working days of receipt through the HR portal.

3.3 Performance Bonus

The annual performance bonus is paid in April each year and is based on the following criteria:

- Individual Performance Rating from the April appraisal cycle (carries 70% weightage).
- Company EBITDA performance against annual targets (carries 30% weightage).
- Employees must be on the rolls of the company as of March 31st to be eligible for that year's bonus.
- Employees who join between January and March receive a prorated bonus for the months worked.
- Employees under a Performance Improvement Plan as of March 31st are not eligible for the bonus that year.

3.4 Health Insurance

Nexora Technologies provides group health insurance to all permanent employees and their immediate family members (spouse and up to 2 children) at no premium cost to the employee. Key details:

- Sum insured: INR 5,00,000 per family per annum.
- Coverage includes: Hospitalization, day-care procedures, maternity (up to INR 50,000 per delivery after 9 months of policy), and pre/post-hospitalization expenses (30 days / 60 days respectively).
- Pre-existing conditions are covered from Day 1 (no waiting period) for employees. Family members have a 30-day waiting period.
- Cashless treatment available at all network hospitals. For non-network hospitals, reimbursement must be claimed within 30 days of discharge.
- Additional top-up insurance (up to INR 10,00,000) is available at employee cost through the HR portal.

3.5 Travel & Expense Reimbursement

Business Travel

Employees undertaking official travel must obtain prior approval from their reporting manager and HR. Travel advances may be requested for trips exceeding 3 days. All expenses must be submitted within 15 working days of trip completion along with original receipts.

Expense Category	Reimbursement Limit
Domestic Air Travel (Economy class only)	Actual cost, capped at INR 12,000 per sector for Band 1-4; INR 18,000 for Band 5+.
Hotel Accommodation (Domestic)	INR 3,500/night for Tier-2 cities; INR 5,500/night for Metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata) for Band 1-4.
Local Conveyance	Actual cab/auto fare with receipts. Ola/Uber accepted. Personal vehicle: INR 12/km.
Daily Food Allowance (DA)	INR 600/day for domestic travel. No receipts required for DA.
International Travel	Governed by the International Travel Policy document. Requires CPO approval.

Other Reimbursements

- Internet Allowance (WFH): INR 1,000 per month for employees under hybrid/remote arrangement. Claimed quarterly via HR portal.
- Mobile Phone Bill: INR 750/month for Band 3 and above, INR 500/month for Band 1-2. Claimed monthly.
- Professional Development: Up to INR 25,000 per year for courses, certifications, or books relevant to the employee's role. Requires manager approval before purchase.

Section 4: Performance Management & Appraisals

Nexora Technologies follows a structured annual performance review cycle to ensure employees receive timely, fair, and constructive feedback. Performance ratings directly influence increments, bonuses, and career progression decisions.

4.1 Performance Review Cycle

Month	Activity
January – March	Goal setting for the new financial year. Employees set 5-7 SMART goals in alignment with department OKRs. Goals must be finalized by March 15th.
July	Mid-year check-in. Informal review between employee and manager to discuss progress, recalibrate goals if needed, and identify development areas. No formal rating is given.
January (following year)	Annual performance review. Employee completes self-assessment; manager provides written feedback and a numeric rating.
February – March	Calibration sessions and increment/bonus decisions finalized by the Compensation Committee.
April	Increment letters issued and performance bonuses credited.

4.2 Performance Rating Scale

Rating	Description & Outcome
5 – Exceptional	Consistently exceeds all goals and demonstrates extraordinary impact. Eligible for highest increment band (12-18% of CTC) and full bonus. Fast-track promotion consideration.
4 – Exceeds Expectations	Exceeds most goals with notable contributions. Increment band: 8-12%. Full bonus eligible.
3 – Meets Expectations	Achieves all defined goals satisfactorily. Increment band: 4-8%. Full bonus eligible.
2 – Partially Meets Expectations	Falls short on some key goals. Increment band: 0-4%. Reduced bonus (50%). A development plan is discussed.
1 – Does Not Meet Expectations	Fails to meet most goals. No increment. No bonus. Employee is placed on a 90-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).

4.3 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

A Performance Improvement Plan is a structured 90-day development program initiated when an employee receives a rating of 1 or shows persistent underperformance. Key aspects:

- A written PIP document is prepared jointly by HR and the reporting manager, outlining specific performance gaps, measurable improvement targets, and weekly milestones.
- The employee meets with their manager every 2 weeks during the PIP period to review progress.

- Successful completion of PIP results in the employee returning to normal performance management.
- Failure to meet PIP targets may result in further disciplinary action, including termination of employment.
- Employees on PIP are not eligible for WFH, internal transfers, or promotions during the PIP period.

4.4 Promotions & Career Progression

Promotions at Nexora Technologies are merit-based and are evaluated annually during the appraisal cycle. Eligibility criteria include:

- Minimum 18 months in the current role/band.
- Performance rating of 4 or 5 in the most recent appraisal.
- Recommendation by the reporting manager and approval by the department head.
- Availability of a role at the next band level within the department or organization.

Section 5: Code of Conduct & Disciplinary Policy

Nexora Technologies expects all employees to uphold the highest standards of professional behavior, integrity, and respect in the workplace. This section defines expected conduct and the consequences of violations.

5.1 Expected Standards of Conduct

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and professionalism regardless of role, gender, religion, caste, nationality, or sexual orientation.
- Protect confidential company information and client data at all times.
- Use company resources (hardware, software, email, internet) solely for legitimate business purposes.
- Declare any conflict of interest (e.g., personal investment in a vendor, relationship with a competitor) to HR immediately.
- Adhere to all data protection and cybersecurity policies outlined in the IT Security Handbook.
- Maintain punctuality and reliability in fulfilling work responsibilities.

5.2 Prohibited Conduct

The following behaviors constitute serious violations of the Code of Conduct and will be subject to disciplinary action:

- Harassment, bullying, intimidation, or discrimination of any kind.
- Dishonesty, fraud, falsification of records, or misrepresentation of work.
- Unauthorized disclosure of proprietary information or intellectual property.
- Workplace violence or threats of violence.
- Consumption of alcohol or use of illegal substances on company premises or during working hours.
- Moonlighting (holding employment at another company) without written permission from HR.
- Accepting gifts, cash, or benefits from vendors or clients exceeding INR 2,000 in value without disclosure.

5.3 Disciplinary Process

Violations of the Code of Conduct are handled through a structured disciplinary process to ensure fairness:

6. Complaint / Observation: A formal complaint is filed with HR, or HR proactively identifies a violation.
7. Preliminary Inquiry: HR conducts a preliminary investigation within 5 working days to determine if there is sufficient basis to proceed.
8. Show Cause Notice: If warranted, a written Show Cause Notice is issued to the employee, who has 5 working days to respond in writing.
9. Disciplinary Committee Review: A committee consisting of the HR Manager, Department Head, and an independent senior leader reviews the case.

10. Decision & Action: The committee issues a written decision within 10 working days. Possible outcomes include: Verbal Warning, Written Warning, Final Written Warning, Suspension Without Pay, or Termination.
11. Appeal: The employee may appeal the decision to the CPO within 7 working days of receiving the outcome.

Section 6: Separation & Exit Policy

This section covers the procedures and entitlements applicable when an employee separates from Nexora Technologies, whether through resignation, termination, or retirement.

6.1 Notice Period

Employee Band / Tenure	Notice Period
Band 1-2 (up to 1 year of service)	30 days
Band 1-2 (more than 1 year of service)	45 days
Band 3-4 (all tenures)	60 days
Band 5 and above	90 days
During Probation Period	15 days

Notice periods may be bought out (Notice Pay in Lieu) by either party by mutual written agreement. The notice period begins from the date the resignation letter is formally accepted by HR, not the date it is submitted.

6.2 Resignation Procedure

12. Submit a formal resignation letter to your reporting manager and cc HR at hr@nexora.in.
13. HR will acknowledge receipt within 2 working days and confirm your last working day based on the applicable notice period.
14. An exit interview will be scheduled by HR within the first week of the notice period.
15. Complete the full and final settlement (FnF) checklist, including handover of responsibilities, return of company assets, and knowledge transfer.
16. The relieving letter and experience certificate will be issued within 30 working days of the last working day, provided all dues and handover requirements are fulfilled.

6.3 Full & Final Settlement

The Full and Final Settlement (FnF) will include the following components:

- Salary for days worked in the final month.
- Leave encashment for pending Earned Leave balance (up to the maximum permissible balance).
- Performance bonus prorated to months worked (if applicable, based on the bonus cycle).
- Gratuity (applicable only for employees with 5 or more years of continuous service).
- Recovery of Notice Pay shortfall (if the employee does not serve the full notice period).
- Recovery of outstanding advances or loans.

FnF payment is typically processed within 45 working days of the last working day, subject to successful completion of all exit formalities. No-dues clearance from IT, Admin, Finance, and the reporting manager is a prerequisite for FnF processing.

6.4 Rehire Policy

Former employees (commonly referred to as 'boomerang employees') are eligible for rehire at Nexora Technologies if they separated on good terms (i.e., no disciplinary termination, full notice served, no dues pending). Rehired employees are treated as fresh hires for the purpose of probation, leave accrual, and gratuity. Their previous tenure with the company is acknowledged in their experience records but does not count toward gratuity or notice period calculations for the new tenure.

Section 7: Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

Nexora Technologies is firmly committed to maintaining a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace for all employees. In compliance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, the company has constituted an Internal Committee (IC) to address complaints.

7.1 Definition of Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome act or behavior (whether directly or by implication) such as:

- Physical contact and advances.
- Demand or request for sexual favours.
- Making sexually coloured remarks, jokes, or gestures.
- Showing pornography or sexually explicit material.
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

These behaviors are prohibited in the workplace, during work-related events, on business travel, and in digital communications including email, WhatsApp, and social media.

7.2 Internal Committee (IC)

The Internal Committee consists of a Presiding Officer (a senior female employee), two employee members, and one external member from an NGO or legal background. The IC contact can be reached at ic@nexora.in. The composition of the IC is reviewed annually and is published on the HR portal.

7.3 Complaint Procedure

17. The aggrieved employee must submit a written complaint to the IC within 3 months of the incident. Extensions may be granted in exceptional circumstances.
18. The IC will send an acknowledgement within 7 working days and initiate an inquiry.
19. Inquiry proceedings are to be completed within 90 days. Both parties will be given a fair opportunity to present their case.
20. The IC will submit a report with findings and recommendations to the management within 10 days of completing the inquiry.
21. Management will implement the recommended action within 60 days of receiving the report.

Confidentiality Assurance

The identity of the complainant, the respondent, and all inquiry proceedings are strictly confidential. Any employee found to be victimizing or retaliating against a complainant will be subject to severe disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

HR Contacts & Escalation Directory

For any HR-related queries not covered in this document, please reach out to the appropriate contact listed below. All queries submitted via the HR portal are assigned a ticket number and resolved within the SLA mentioned.

Query Type	Contact / SLA
General HR Queries	hr@nexora.in HR Portal Ticket SLA: 3 working days
Leave & Attendance Issues	attendance@nexora.in SLA: 2 working days
Payroll & Salary Queries	payroll@nexora.in SLA: 5 working days
POSH / Harassment Complaints	ic@nexora.in Confidential SLA: 7 working days
Performance & Appraisals	performance@nexora.in SLA: 5 working days
Health Insurance Claims	insurance@nexora.in SLA: 3 working days
Exit & FnF Queries	exits@nexora.in SLA: 7 working days
Disciplinary Matters	conduct@nexora.in Confidential SLA: 5 working days

Document Revision History
v1.0 (Jan 2022): Initial policy release.
v2.0 (Jan 2023): Updated maternity leave (26 weeks), added internet allowance for WFH.
v3.0 (Jan 2024): Added paternity leave (10 days), updated travel reimbursement limits.
v3.2 (Jan 2025): Updated hybrid WFH policy, revised performance rating outcomes, added rehire policy.

This document supersedes all previous versions of the HR Policy Manual.

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